Anaconda vs VS Code Built-in Python

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Why Anaconda + VS Code is the Recommended Setup

Comparison Table

Aspect	**Anaconda (Recommended)**	**VS Code Built-in / System Python**
Package Management	Excellent (conda + pip)	Only pip — frequent conflicts
Environment Isolation	Very easy (`conda create -n risk_model`)	Manual and error-prone
Complex Packages (XGBoost, SHAP, etc.)	Reliable & stable	Often causes installation errors
Reproducibility	High (`environment.yml`)	Low
Stability for Banking Work	Preferred in financial institutions	Acceptable but riskier

| Long-term Maintenance | Easy to share and reproduce | More difficult |

Key Benefits of Using Anaconda

1. **Isolated Environments** — Prevents package version conflicts between different projects.

2. **Reliable Installation** of data science and machine learning libraries.

3. **Better for Regulatory & Production Work** — Easier to maintain consistent environments.

4. **Export Full Environment** for sharing:

   ```bash

   conda env export > environment.yml
   ```